

**UNITED STATES PATENT AND TRADEMARK OFFICE
BEFORE THE DIRECTOR OF THE
UNITED STATES PATENT AND TRADEMARK OFFICE**

In the Matter of	)	
	)	
Maria G. Worley,	)	Proceeding No. D2025-11
	)	
Respondent	)	
_____	)	

FINAL ORDER

The Acting Deputy General Counsel for Enrollment and Discipline and the Acting Director of the Office of Enrollment and Discipline (“OED Director”) for the United States Patent and Trademark Office (“USPTO” or “Office”) and Ms. Maria G. Worley (“Respondent”), have submitted a Proposed Settlement Agreement (“Agreement”) to the Under Secretary of Commerce for Intellectual Property and Director of the United States Patent and Trademark Office (“USPTO Director”) for approval.

The Agreement, which resolves all disciplinary action by the USPTO arising from the Joint Stipulated Facts set forth below, is hereby approved. This Final Order sets forth the parties’ stipulated facts, legal conclusions, and sanctions.

Jurisdiction

1. At all times relevant hereto, Respondent of Brooklyn, New York, was an attorney admitted to practice in the State of New York in good standing (NY Registration No. 4354965). Respondent, at all times relevant to this matter, was engaged in practice before the Office in trademark matters. Respondent is authorized to practice before the USPTO in trademark matters. *See* 5 U.S.C. § 500(b); 37 C.F.R. § 11.14(a). Respondent is subject to the USPTO Rules of Professional Conduct, 37 C.F.R. § 11.101 *et seq.*
2. The USPTO Director has jurisdiction over this matter pursuant to 35 U.S.C. §§ 2(b)(2)(D) and 32 and 37 C.F.R. §§ 11.19, 11.20, and 11.26.

Background

3. Effective August 3, 2019, any foreign-domiciled trademark applicant or registrant must be represented before the USPTO by an attorney who is licensed to practice in the United States. *See* 37 C.F.R. § 2.11(a); *Requirement of U.S. Licensed Attorney for Foreign Trademark Applicants and Registrants*, 84 Fed. Reg. 31498 (July 2, 2019) (“the U.S. Counsel Rule”).
4. The requirement for representation by a qualified U.S. attorney is necessary to enforce compliance by all foreign-domiciled applicants, registrants, and parties with U.S. statutory and regulatory requirements in trademark matters. *See* 84 Fed. Reg. 31498. A policy objective of the U.S. Counsel Rule is to instill greater confidence in the public that U.S. registrations issued to

foreign-domiciled applicants are not subject to invalidation for reasons such as improper signatures. *See id.* at 31507.

5. The U.S. Counsel Rule's requirement for U.S. licensed attorneys to represent foreign-domiciled applicants was intended to (a) increase compliance with U.S. trademark law and USPTO regulations; (b) improve the accuracy of trademark submissions to the USPTO; and (c) safeguard the integrity of the U.S. trademark registry. *Id.*

6. In 2019, also as part of the USPTO's effort to protect the integrity of the trademark register, the USPTO began requiring customers to create a USPTO.gov account to access and submit electronic trademark forms.

7. Attorneys may open and use their own USPTO.gov account to represent trademark applicants before the USPTO. USPTO.gov account holders are bound by the USPTO Trademark Verified Account Agreement.

8. USPTO.gov account holders are not permitted to share their account credentials with others.

9. Attorneys may also sponsor USPTO.gov accounts for a reasonable number of their support staff. USPTO sponsorship of support staff is limited to certain persons, namely: support staff: (a) who are directly employed or retained by the attorney, the attorney's company, or the attorney's law firm; and (b) who work under the attorney's supervision.

10. Sponsoring attorneys agree that they will not attempt to sponsor any unauthorized individuals, including any foreign or domestic company, group, client, agent, attorney, or other practitioner.

11. The USPTO has identified that some attorneys have violated the Trademark Verified Account Agreement by sponsoring foreign agents and attorneys who are not directly supervised support staff. In response to this, on September 5, 2023, the USPTO issued a new rule making identity verification for support staff available beginning on October 14, 2023, and requiring identity verification for all support staff users beginning January 20, 2024. *See Requiring Identity Verification for Attorney-Sponsored Accounts*, 88 Fed. Reg. 60667 (Sept. 5, 2023).

12. Sponsoring attorneys agree to take reasonable steps to ensure that the support staff's access and use of the USPTO systems is consistent with the tasks assigned to the support staff and to immediately remove sponsorship for any individual who has knowingly submitted false signatures.

13. The USPTO trademark signature rules require that: (a) all signatures on trademark documents be signed by a proper person, (b) trademark documents be personally signed by the signatory named on the document, and (c) a person electronically signing a document must personally enter any combination of letters, numbers, spaces, and/or punctuation marks that he or she has adopted as a signature and that combination be placed between two forward slash ("/") symbols in the signature block on the electronic submission. *See* 37 C.F.R. §§ 2.193(a), (c), and (e). *See also* Trademark Manual of Examining Procedure § 611.01(c) and 37 C.F.R. § 11.18(a).

14. A trademark submission that is signed by a person other than the named signatory is

improperly executed and cannot be relied upon to support registration. *See In re Yusha Zhang*, 2021 Commr. Pat. LEXIS 2 at *10 (Dir. USPTO 2021); *Ex parte Hipkins*, Appeal No. 90-2250, 1991 Pat. App. LEXIS 14, at *10-13 (BPAI 1991); *In re Cowan*, Reg. No. 1225389, 1990 Commr. Pat. LEXIS 24, at *5-6 (Comm'r Pats. 1990).

15. If a trademark signature fails to comply with 37 C.F.R. § 2.193(a) or (e) because it was entered by someone other than the named signatory or not signed by a proper person, the trademark may be subject to cancellation. *See* 84 Fed. Reg. at 31498 (stating that “[i]f signed by a person determined to be an unauthorized signatory, a resulting registration may be invalid.”). *See also In re Dermahose Inc.*, 82 U.S.P.Q.2d 1793 (T.T.A.B. 2007); *In re Cowan*, 18 U.S.P.Q.2d 1407 (Comm'r Pat. & Trademarks 1990). When trademark filings are impermissibly signed and filed with the USPTO, the integrity of the federal trademark registration process is adversely affected.

16. A signature that does not meet the “personally signed” or “personally entered” requirements, *see* 37 C.F.R. §§2.193(a), (f), 11.18(a), “may jeopardize the validity of [an] application or registration.” 37 C.F.R. §2.193(f). Thus, these signature requirements are not merely technical in nature but rather are substantive. *See In re Stelcore Management Services, LLC*, 2025 Comm'r. Pat. at *3 (Final Order for Sanctions June 13, 2025).

17. “Submitting a document that includes false, misleading, fictitious, or fraudulent information or representations violates 37 C.F.R. §11.18(b)(1). This includes, for example, false or misleading domicile information, attorney information, signatory information (*e.g.*, where the named signatory did not personally enter his or her signature on the document), applicant information, or claims of use (or intent to use). Submitting a document without undertaking a reasonable inquiry into the factual basis for the averments, without evidentiary support, in an effort to circumvent USPTO Rules, or coupled with other rule or Terms of Use violations constitutes an improper purpose and violates 37 C.F.R. §11.18(b)(2).” *In re Stelcore Management Services, LLC*, *supra* at *6.

18. “Any party who uses USPTO systems, including the USPTO.gov website and electronic filing systems, is bound by both the Terms of Use for USPTO websites and the USPTO Trademark Verified USPTO.gov Account Agreement. Under the Terms of Use, registration for, and use of, a USPTO.gov account is limited to the individual to whom the account is registered, and the registered individual is responsible for all activities occurring under that account and any sponsored accounts. Use of a USPTO.gov account to submit, access, or alter information exceeding one’s authority not only breaches the Terms of Use, but may also violate other USPTO Rules including but not limited to 37 C.F.R. §§ 2.193(f) and 11.18(b).” *In re Stelcore Management Services, LLC*, *supra* at *6-7.

Joint Stipulated Facts

19. Respondent is the founding attorney of Startlaw P.C., a New York law firm providing legal services to startups, and first became familiar with trademark law through representing startup corporations. Respondent began representing trademark applicants before the USPTO in 2021.

20. Respondent was solicited online by several individuals seeking U.S. counsel for foreign-domiciled trademark applicants. She filed her first trademark application for a foreign-domiciled

client in late 2021.

21. Respondent accepted referrals from several individuals including: (a) Chean Fonk Thong, who is the owner of startfleet.io, a business incorporation service in the U.S., and (b) Maryam Younas, who Respondent knew as an individual licensed to practice law in Pakistan.

22. Mr. Thong and Ms. Younas were not Respondent's support staff and did not work under Respondent's supervision. In violation of the Verified USPTO.gov Account Agreement, Respondent sponsored USPTO.gov accounts for Mr. Thong and Ms. Younas.

23. Mr. Thong and Ms. Younas improperly utilized their USPTO.gov sponsored accounts to file unauthorized trademark applications. Some of the filings identified Respondent as the named attorney on the application, which Respondent represents she was not aware of because Mr. Thong and Ms. Younas did not use email addresses that Respondent had access to or was even aware of.

24. Respondent acknowledges that she would have been aware of these unauthorized applications had she conducted regular searches on the USPTO's online trademark system, which would have revealed the unauthorized and improper use of her credentials and signature on applications filed with the USPTO. By regularly and frequently searching the USPTO's online trademark search system with the search phrase AT: maria AND AT: worley AND FD: [YYYYMMDD TO YYYYMMDD] and comparing any search results to the list of actual application filings kept by Respondent, she would have discovered the unauthorized applications. Respondent represents that it did not occur to her to perform such a search.

25. Respondent provided documentation showing that she undertook due diligence and vetted Mr. Thong and Ms. Younas thoroughly prior to sponsoring each, including interviewing each before sponsoring USPTO.gov accounts for them. Moreover, Respondent provided documentation to OED that she believes supports her assertion that no reasonable tool exists to monitor sponsored accounts using the USPTO's systems.

26. Mr. Thong shared his USPTO.gov account credentials with Mr. Abdul Akram, an individual involved in the unauthorized practice of trademark law before the USPTO.

27. Mr. Thong and Mr. Akram used Mr. Thong's sponsored account to submit trademark documents to the USPTO containing Respondent's purported signature that Respondent did not sign or authorize.

28. Similarly, Ms. Younas utilized the USPTO.gov account Respondent sponsored to submit trademark documents to the USPTO containing Respondent's purported signature that Respondent did not sign or authorize.

29. On several occasions, Ms. Younas also utilized Respondent's own USPTO.gov account to sign and file unauthorized trademark documents with the USPTO. Respondent represents that it is unclear to her how this occurred as she represents that she did not share her credentials with Ms. Younas.

30. After receiving a copy of the grievance and request for information in this matter, which Respondent represents made her aware of Mr. Thong's and Ms. Younas's unauthorized activities, Respondent terminated Mr. Thong's and Ms. Younas's sponsored USPTO.gov accounts.

31. After reviewing all filings under her name, Respondent provided a spreadsheet of unauthorized applications to OED and the Office of the Deputy Commissioner for Trademark Examination Policy.

Additional Considerations

32. Respondent has never been the subject of professional discipline by the USPTO and represents that she has not been subject to discipline by any court or any state bar.

33. Respondent understands and acknowledges that (a) the USPTO trademark signature rule requiring the named signatory to enter his or her signature on a trademark document to be presented to the Office is a substantive rule, not a technical requirement and (b) a failure of the named signatory to enter his or her signature on a trademark document potentially adversely affects trademark applicants' and trademark registrants' intellectual property rights as well as the integrity of the USPTO trademark registration process.

34. Respondent acknowledges that she was mistaken in believing that a sponsoring attorney is unable to monitor the use of sponsored USPTO.gov accounts.

35. Respondent further acknowledges the value in regularly and frequently searching the USPTO's online trademark search system for applications naming him or her as the current attorney of record for applications filed over a given period of time to find unauthorized filings by comparing any search results to the list of actual application filings kept by the sponsoring attorney.

36. Respondent has demonstrated genuine contrition and accepted responsibility for her acts and omissions.

37. Respondent has informed the Deputy Commissioner for Trademark Examination Policy of the unauthorized filings and provided an itemized list of the associated filings.

38. Respondent cooperated with OED's investigation, *e.g.*, by participating in an online interview with OED and by providing timely, candid, and non-evasive responses to requests for information.

Joint Legal Conclusions

39. Respondent acknowledges that, based on the information contained in the Joint Stipulated Facts above, Respondent's acts and omissions violated the following provisions of the USPTO Rules of Professional Conduct:

- a) 37 C.F.R. § 11.101 (a practitioner shall provide competent representation) by, *inter alia*, not understanding and/or following the USPTO verified account

agreement by sponsoring USPTO.gov accounts for unauthorized individuals, namely Chean Fonk Thong and Maryam Younas;

- b) 37 C.F.R. § 11.103 (not acting with reasonable diligence) by, *inter alia*, sponsoring USPTO.gov accounts for unauthorized individuals; and
- c) 37 C.F.R. § 11.804(d) (engaging in conduct that is prejudicial to the integrity of the trademark system) by, *inter alia*, sponsoring USPTO.gov accounts for unauthorized individuals, namely Chean Fonk Thong and Maryam Younas.

Agreed-Upon Sanction

40. Respondent freely and voluntarily agrees, and it is hereby ORDERED, that:

- a. Respondent is reprimanded and placed on probation for a period of twelve (12) months;
- b. Respondent shall cooperate fully with the USPTO in any present or future USPTO inquiry made into improper trademark filings by (1) Chean Fonk Thong and any entity affiliated with Mr. Thong, (2) Maryam Younas and any entity affiliated with Ms. Younas, (3) Abdul Wahab Akram and any entity affiliated with Mr. Akram, (4) any other person or entity with whom Respondent has worked in connection with her trademark practice, or (5) any other person or entity into which such an inquiry is being made;
- c. Respondent shall serve a probationary period that commences on the date this Final Order is signed and terminates twelve (12) months after this Final Order is signed;
- d. (1) If the OED Director is of the good faith opinion that Respondent, during Respondent's probationary period, failed to comply with any provision of the Agreement, this Final Order, or any provision of the USPTO Rules of Professional Conduct, the OED Director shall:

(A) issue to Respondent an Order to Show Cause why the USPTO Director should not enter an order immediately suspending the Respondent for up to thirty (30) days for the violations set forth in the Joint Legal Conclusions, above;

(B) send the Order to Show Cause to Respondent at the last address of record Respondent furnished to the OED Director;

(C) grant Respondent fifteen (15) days to respond to the Order to Show Cause; and

(2) in the event that after the fifteen (15) day period for response and consideration of the response, if any, received from Respondent, the OED Director continues to be of the opinion that Respondent, during Respondent's probationary period, failed to comply with the USPTO Rules of Professional Conduct, the OED Director shall:

(A) deliver to the USPTO Director: (i) the Order to Show Cause; (ii) Respondent's response to the Order to Show Cause, if any; and (iii) argument and

evidence supporting the OED Director's position; and

(B) request that the USPTO Director enter an order immediately suspending Respondent for up to thirty (30) days for the violations set forth in the Joint Legal Conclusions above;

- e. Nothing herein shall prevent the OED Director from seeking discrete discipline for any misconduct that formed the basis for an Order to Show Cause issued pursuant to the preceding subparagraph;
- f. In the event the Respondent seeks a review of any action taken pursuant to subparagraph d., above, such review shall not operate to postpone or otherwise hold in abeyance the suspension;
- g. While Respondent is on probation, Respondent shall, at least on a weekly basis, (i) search the USPTO's online trademark search system (currently located at <https://tmsearch.uspto.gov/search/search-information>) for applications identifying her as the attorney of record; and (ii) promptly inform in writing the USPTO Office of Trademark Examination Policy of each trademark document filing identifying her as the attorney of record that was made without her knowledge or consent;
- h. While Respondent is on probation, Respondent shall, at least every three months, submit a written report to the OED Director stating that she has completed the monthly searches of the USPTO's online trademark search system database, and, as applicable, (i) stating that she identified no applications or other trademark filing in which she was named as the attorney of record that were made without her knowledge and consent or (ii) providing copies of correspondence sent to the USPTO Office of Trademark Examination Policy as described in the preceding subparagraph;
- i. Nothing in this Final Order shall prevent the Office from considering the record of this disciplinary proceeding, including this Final Order: (1) when addressing any further complaint or evidence of similar misconduct concerning Respondent brought to the attention of the Office; and/or (2) in any future disciplinary proceeding against Respondent (i) as an aggravating factor to be taken into consideration in determining any discipline to be imposed, and/or (ii) to rebut any statement or representation by or on Respondent's behalf; and/or (3) in connection with any request for reconsideration submitted by Respondent pursuant to 37 C.F.R. § 11.60;
- j. The OED Director shall electronically publish this Final Order publicly including at the OED's electronic FOIA Reading Room, which is publicly accessible through the Office's website at: <https://foiadocuments.uspto.gov/oed/>;
- k. The OED Director shall publish a notice publicly including in the Official Gazette that is materially consistent with the following:

Notice of Reprimand and Probation

This notice concerns Maria G. Worley of Brooklyn, New York. Ms. Worley is an attorney

licensed in the State of New York (NY Registration No. 4354965) who engaged in practice before the United States Patent and Trademark Office (“USPTO”) or (“Office”) in trademark matters. The USPTO Director has reprimanded Ms. Worley and placed her on probation for violating 37 C.F.R. §§ 11.101, 11.103, and 11.804(d) of the USPTO Rules of Professional Conduct.

In connection with her representation of foreign-domiciled trademark clients before the USPTO as a U.S. licensed attorney under the USPTO’s U.S. Counsel Rule, Ms. Worley sponsored USPTO.gov accounts for two individuals who were not authorized to be sponsored and, thereafter, did not adequately monitor the use of the sponsored accounts. The two individuals impermissibly signed and filed trademark documents for foreign-domiciled trademark applicants under Ms. Worley’s name and credentials. Ms. Worley represented to OED that many trademark applications were filed under her name and bar credentials without her knowledge or authorization.

Ms. Worley has not been previously disciplined by the USPTO, and she represents that she has never been the subject of professional discipline by any court or state bar. Most of the trademark filings Ms. Worley prepared on behalf of foreign-domiciled clients were properly signed and filed with the USPTO in accordance with the USPTO signature requirements.

On August 3, 2019, the Office’s “U.S. Counsel Rule” took effect. It requires any foreign-domiciled trademark applicant or registrant to be represented before the USPTO by an attorney licensed to practice law in the United States. *See* 37 C.F.R. § 2.11(a); Requirement of U.S. Licensed Attorney for Foreign Trademark Applicants and Registrants, 84 Fed. Reg. 31498 (July 2, 2019) (“the U.S. Counsel Rule”).

The requirement for representation by a qualified U.S. attorney is necessary to enforce compliance by all foreign-domiciled applicants, registrants, and parties with U.S. statutory and regulatory requirements in trademark matters. *See* 84 Fed. Reg. 31498. A policy objective of the U.S. Counsel Rule is to instill greater confidence in the public that U.S. registrations issued to foreign-domiciled applicants are not subject to invalidation for reasons such as improper signatures. *See id.* at 31507. The rule (a) increases compliance with U.S. trademark law and USPTO regulations, (b) improves the accuracy of trademark submissions to the USPTO, and (c) safeguards the integrity of the U.S. trademark register. *See id.* at 31498.

The U.S. Counsel Rule not only aids the USPTO in its efforts to improve and preserve the integrity of the U.S. trademark register, but it also ensures that foreign-domiciled applicants, registrants, and parties are assisted only by authorized practitioners who are subject to the USPTO’s disciplinary rules. *See id.*

A practitioner’s failure to comply with his or her ethical obligations under the U.S. Counsel Rule potentially adversely affects the integrity of the USPTO trademark registration process. *See, e.g., In re Yang*, Proceeding No. D2021-11 (USPTO Dec. 17, 2021).

The USPTO has often affirmatively informed trademark practitioners as to its trademark rules of practice as evidenced, for example, by the ample and readily available information regarding what is competent practice before the Office in trademark matters. In particular, the agency maintains a webpage regarding important trademark information including specific links to relevant laws, rules, regulations, and rulemaking (www.uspto.gov/trademarks). For example, as far back as December 10, 2020, the agency released a still-available webinar entitled “Representation, signatures, and ethics in trademark cases” accessible at <https://www.uspto.gov/learning-and-resources/uspto-videos/representation-signatures-and-ethical-issues-trademark-cases> as is part of a multi-chaptered Trademark Webinar Series).

Further, the agency publishes online and regularly updates its Trademark Manual of Examining Procedure (“TMEP”)(tmep.uspto.gov/RDMS/TMEP/current). The TMEP is a guidance document that provides trademark practitioners, *inter alia*, with a reference work on the practices and procedures relative to prosecution of applications to register marks in the USPTO. For example, TMEP § 611.01 provides clear guidance on the agency’s signature rules, including that (a) the person(s) identified as the signatory must personally sign the document (e.g., a paralegal, legal assistant, or secretary may not sign or enter the name of an attorney or other authorized signatory), (b) a person may not delegate their authority to sign, and (c) no person may use document-signing software to enter or electronically generate someone else’s signature. A trademark submission that is signed by a person other than the named signatory is improperly executed and cannot be relied upon to support registration. *See In re Yusha Zhang*, 2021 Commr. Pat. LEXIS 2 at *10 (Dir. USPTO 2021); *Ex parte Hipkins*, Appeal No. 90-2250, 1991 Pat. App. LEXIS 14, at *10-13 (BPAI 1991); *In re Cowan*, Reg. No. 1225389, 1990 Commr. Pat. LEXIS 24, at *5-6 (Comm’r Pats. 1990).

A signature that does not meet the “personally signed” or “personally entered” requirements, *see* 37 C.F.R. §§2.193(a), (f), 11.18(a), “may jeopardize the validity of [an] application or registration.” 37 C.F.R. §2.193(f). Thus, these signature requirements are not merely technical in nature but rather are substantive. *See In re Stelcore Management Services, LLC*, 2025 Comm’r. Pat. at *3 (Final Order for Sanctions June 13, 2025).

“Submitting a document that includes false, misleading, fictitious, or fraudulent information or representations violates 37 C.F.R. §11.18(b)(1). This includes, for example, false or misleading domicile information, attorney information, signatory information (e.g., where the named signatory did not personally enter his or her signature on the document), applicant information, or claims of use (or intent to use). Submitting a document without undertaking a reasonable inquiry into the factual basis for the averments, without evidentiary support, in an effort to circumvent USPTO Rules, or coupled with other rule or Terms of Use violations constitutes an improper purpose and violates 37 C.F.R. §11.18(b)(2).” *In re Stelcore Management Services, LLC*, *supra* at *6.

“Any party who uses USPTO systems, including the USPTO.gov website and electronic filing systems, is bound by both the Terms of Use for USPTO websites and the USPTO

Trademark Verified USPTO.gov Account Agreement. Under the Terms of Use, registration for, and use of, a USPTO.gov account is limited to the individual to whom the account is registered, and the registered individual is responsible for all activities occurring under that account and any sponsored accounts. Use of a USPTO.gov account to submit, access, or alter information exceeding one's authority not only breaches the Terms of Use, but may also violate other USPTO Rules including but not limited to 37 C.F.R. §§2.193(f) and 11.18(b).” *In re Stelcore Management Services, LLC*, *supra* at *6-7.

In light of the information that has been publicly available for a long time, practitioners who represent applicants, registrants, or others before the USPTO in trademark matters—including those who serve as U.S. counsel for foreign-domiciled clients—are reasonably expected to know (a) the applicable trademark prosecution and signature rules, (b) the provisions of the USPTO Rules of Professional Conduct implicated by such representation, and (c) the potential disciplinary consequences when such provisions of the USPTO Rules of Professional Conduct are violated.

The USPTO Director has issued numerous orders imposing discipline on practitioners who violated the USPTO Rules of Professional Conduct based on not complying with USPTO trademark signature rules, not adequately supervising non-attorneys, and/or not fulfilling obligations under 37 CFR § 11.18 to conduct an inquiry reasonable under the circumstances in support of factual assertions made in trademark documents presented to the USPTO. Such orders have, and continue to, affirmatively assist trademark practitioners to the agency's rules of practice and the provisions of the professional code of conduct involved in practice before the Office in trademark matters. Some of those orders include the following:

In re Erik B. Jensen, Proceeding No. D2009-46 (Feb. 18, 2010 Final Order)
In re Allen A. Meyer, Proceeding No. D2010-41 (Sep. 7, 2011 Final Order)
In re Shia, Bang-er, Proceeding No. D2010-41 (April 22, 2015 Initial Decision)
In re Shia, Bang-er, Proceeding No. D2010-41 (Mar. 4, 2016 Final Order)
In re Shia, Bang-er, Proceeding No. D2010-41 (Aug. 1, 2016 Order on Reconsideration)
In re Matthew Swyers, Proceeding No. D2016-20 (Jan. 26, 2017 Final Order)
In re Reyner Meikle, Proceeding No. D2019-17 (Mar. 21, 2019 Final Order)
In re Travis Crabtree, Proceeding Nos. D2018-31 & -47 (Apr. 25, 2019 Final Order)
In re Heather Sapp, Proceeding No. D2019-31 (May 15, 2019 Final Order)
In re Deborah Sweeney, Proceeding No. D2019-33 (June 19, 2019 Final Order)
In re Anita Mar, Proceeding No. D2019-11 (Aug. 2, 2019 Final Order)
In re Renuka Rajan, Proceeding No. D2019-30 (Sep. 5, 2019 Final Order)
In re Thomas C. Caraco, Proceeding No. D2019-50 (Sep. 12, 2019 Final Order)
In re Lenise Williams, Proceeding No. D2019-23 (Sep. 20, 2019 Final Order)
In re Charles Caldwell II, Proceeding No. D2020-12 (Mar. 17, 2020 Final Order)
In re Jamie Bashtanyk, Proceeding No. D2020-09 (Apr. 17, 2020 Final Order)
In re Yiheng Lou, Proceeding No. D2021-04 (May 12, 2021 Final Order)
In re Andrei Mincov, Proceeding No. D2020-30 (Aug. 23, 2021 Final Order)
In re Devasena Reddy, Proceeding No. D2021-13 (Sep. 9, 2021 Final Order)

In re Bennett David, Proceeding No. D2021-08 (Sep. 24, 2021 Final Order)
In re Di Li, Proceeding No. D2021-16 (Oct. 7, 2021 Final Order)
In re Tony C. Hom, Proceeding No. D2021-10 (Dec. 17, 2021 Final Order)
In re Elizabeth Yang, Proceeding No. D2021-11 (Dec. 17, 2021 Final Order)
In re Elizabeth Pasquine, Proceeding No. D2019-39 (Aug. 13, 2021 Initial Decision)
In re Elizabeth Pasquine, Proceeding No. D2019-39 (Mar. 28, 2022 Final Order)
In re Yi Wan, Proceeding No. D2022-04 (Apr. 1, 2022 Final Order)
In re Kathy Hao, Proceeding No. D2021-14 (Apr. 27, 2022 Final Order)
In re Weibo Zhang, Proceeding No. D2022-16 (July 11, 2022 Final Order)
In re Daoyou Liu, Proceeding No. D2022-03 (Aug. 9, 2022 Final Order)
In re Zhihua Han, Proceeding No. D2022-23 (Jan. 6, 2023 Final Order)
In re Jingfeng Song, Proceeding No. D2023-10 (May 1, 2023 Final Order)
In re Kevin R. Gallagher, Proceeding No. D2023-28 (June 23, 2023 Final Order)
In re Puja Jabbour, Proceeding No. D2023-33 (Sep. 6, 2023 Final Order)
In re Jing Wang, Proceeding No. D2023-38 (Nov. 21, 2023 Final Order)
In re Yue Niu, Proceeding No. D2023-32 (Jan. 3, 2024 Final Order)
In re Grace Lee Huang, Proceeding No. D2023-37 (Jan. 8, 2024 Final Order)
In re Ryan A. Bethell, Proceeding No. D2019-42 (Nov. 20, 2023 Initial Decision)
In re Ryan A. Bethell, Proceeding No. D2019-42 (Jan. 27, 2024 Final Order)
In re Francis Koh, Proceeding No. D2024-07 (Feb. 7, 2024 Final Order)
In re Che-Yang Chen, Proceeding No. D2024-01 (Mar. 20, 2024 Final Order)
In re Julian A. Haffner, Proceeding No. D2023-35 (May 21, 2024 Final Order)
In re Harrison B. Oldham, Proceeding No. D2024-11 (May 29, 2024 Final Order)
In re Wayne Harper, Proceeding Nos. D2020-10 & D2024-15 (Aug. 13, 2024 Final Order)
In re Lan Yu, Proceeding No. D2024-24 (Aug. 20, 2024 Final Order)
In re Ruth K. Khalsa, Proceeding No. D2019-38 (Sep. 5, 2024 Final Order)
In re Weitao Chen, Proceeding No. D2024-21 (Sep. 11, 2024 Final Order)
In re Alexis Campbell, Proceeding No. D2019-41 (Oct. 10, 2024 Final Order)
In re Jie Luo, Proceeding No. D2024-02 (Oct. 25, 2024 Final Order)
In re Qinghe Liu, Proceeding No. D2023-39 (Nov. 21, 2024 Final Order)
In re Angus Ni, Proceeding No. D2024-20 (Dec. 19, 2024 Final Order)
In re Afamefuna Okeke, Proceeding No. D2024-18 (Jan. 6, 2025 Final Order)
In re Nyall S. Engfield, Proceeding No. D2025-12 (Mar. 10, 2025 Final Order)
In re Shan Zhu, Proceeding No. D2024-19 (Mar. 18, 2025 Final Order)
In re Phillip T. Horton, Proceeding No. D2025-15 (Mar. 20, 2025 Final Order)
In re Andrew S. Rapacke, Proceeding No. D2025-16 (Mar. 20, 2025 Final Order)
In re Hao Ni, Proceeding No. D2025-14 (Mar. 31, 2025 Final Order)
In re Curtis Ray Hussey, Proceeding No. D2025-19 (May 14, 2025 Final Order)
In re Xiaofang Zhong, Proceeding No. D2025-18 (May 21, 2025 Final Order)

These cases (as well as all other USPTO disciplinary decisions involving patent and trademark practitioners) are accessible at: <https://foiadocuments.uspto.gov/oed/>.

Further, the USPTO has informed attorneys that sponsoring foreign agents and attorneys who are not supervised support staff may violate the trademark rules and undermine the

trademark register. *See, e.g., Requiring Identity Verification for Attorney- Sponsored Accounts*, 88 FR 60667 (Sept. 5, 2023). Further, attorneys who sponsor USPTO.gov accounts in connection with their trademark practice should regularly and frequently search the USPTO's online trademark search system for applications naming him or her as the current attorney of record for applications filed over a given period of time. The attorney can use the search phrase AT: firstname AND AT: lastname AND FD: [YYYYMMDD TO YYYYMMDD] and then find unauthorized filings by comparing the search results to the list of actual application filings kept by the attorney. If unauthorized filings are found, the attorney should promptly inform the USPTO via TMScams@uspto.gov.

This action is the result of a settlement agreement between Ms. Worley and the OED Director pursuant to the provisions of 35 U.S.C. §§ 2(b)(2)(D) and 32, and 37 C.F.R. §§ 11.19, 11.20, and 11.26. Disciplinary decisions involving practitioners—including the many who have been disciplined for not complying with the USPTO trademark signature rules and their ethical obligations under the USPTO Rules of Professional Conduct connected with serving as counsel for foreign-domiciled trademark applicants—are posted for public reading at the Office of Enrollment and Discipline Reading Room accessible at: <https://foiadocuments.uspto.gov/oed>.

- l. Based on Respondent's agreement to do so, Respondent waives all rights to seek reconsideration of this Final Order under 37 C.F.R. § 11.56, waives the right to have this Final Order reviewed under 37 C.F.R. § 11.57, and waives the right otherwise to appeal or challenge this Final Order in any manner;
- m. The OED Director and Respondent shall each bear their own costs incurred to date and in carrying out the terms of the Agreement and this Final Order.

Users, Choe, Tricia
Digitally signed by Users,
Choe, Tricia
Date: 2025.08.14 09:59:34
-04'00'

Tricia Choe
Associate General Counsel for General Law
United States Patent and Trademark Office

Date

on delegated authority by

Coke Stewart
Acting Under Secretary of Commerce for Intellectual Property and
Acting Director of the United States Patent and Trademark

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that the foregoing Final Order was sent, on this day, to the parties in the manner indicated below:

Via e-mail:

Mr. Emil J. Ali
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Counsel for Respondent Maria G. Worley

Via e-mail:

Sydney O. Johnson
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8/14/2025
Date


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